SUNY Old Westbury 2026-2027 Undergraduate Catalog

Media & Communications, B.A.

The major in Media and Communications provides students with a broad-based education emphasizing theoretical, historical and experiential learning in an interdisciplinary context. This major prepares students for careers and advanced study in media studies, journalism, communications, public relations, and media production.

The B.A. in Media & Communications is grounded in the economic, political, social and intellectual history of the U.S. A wide variety of courses offers theoretical and practical instruction in theory, journalism, broadcast (radio, TV) and new media (podcasting and multimedia/multi-platform digital storytelling). Students will develop strong writing, news reporting, media production, and critical thinking skills to help them assess, and participate in, the complex dynamics of media in contemporary society.

Students also gain practical experience through internships on campus at student media hubs (radio, TV, digital news, and cross-platform media). Proximity to the New York Metropolitan area provides exciting off-campus internship opportunities in a variety of fields such as digital and broadcast news, television, radio/podcasting, sport media, digital journalism, public relations, strategic communications, social media and more.

Students in other majors who are interested in media can minor in Media & Communications or Media Design. The department also offers micro-credentials in AI & Society, Fundamentals of Non-Fiction Video Production and/or Television News Production, Advanced TV/Video Production, Multimedia Journalism, and PR and Strategic Communications.

Evening Students

A limited selection of Media and Communications courses are available in the evening. Completion of a major in Media and Communications typically requires daytime course attendance.

Transfer Students

A Media and Communications major can be completed in a two year period with appropriate planning. With an advisor's approval, a maximum of five courses will be accepted in transfer toward the 12 courses required for the major. Transfer students should note that the "Knowledge of American Society" course as well as AS 2802 - Multimedia Storytelling and AS 3800 - Writing for Media are prerequisites for enrollment in 5000-level American Studies courses, as well as for a number of other courses in the major. It is essential that these requirements be fulfilled in a transfer student's first year at Old Westbury if the expectation of completing the program in two years is to be met. These courses must be taken prior to the senior year.

Combined B.A. in Media & Communications / M.A. in Liberal Studies

The combined B.A. in Media & Communications/M.A. in Liberal Studies program allows qualified undergraduate students to accelerate their progress toward a master's degree. This can save time and cut overall tuition costs. Applicants will major in Media & Communications at the undergraduate level. They will complete the requirements for that B.A. degree while beginning a portion of the graduate M.A. in Liberal Studies program in their senior year. For more information, visit the MALS webpage: https://www.oldwestbury.edu/programs-courses/liberal-studies-ma.

Requirements for the B.A. in Media and Communications (48 credits)

The major consists of twelve courses in the following categories:

1. Knowledge of American Society (4 credits)

Students select one of the following courses, ideally as early as possible and no later than the junior year.

- AS 2252 - U.S. Social Movements Credits: 4
- AS 2262 - African American History I Credits: 4
- AS 2263 - African American History II Credits: 4
- AS 2300 - US Environmental History Credits: 4
- AS 2640 - U.S. Latina/o History Credits: 4
- AS 3215 - Crime, Protest, and Policing Credits: 4
- AS 3222 - Urban History Credits: 4
- AS 3270 - Africa in the Americas Credits: 4
- AS 3462 - History of Women in the U.S. Credits: 4
- AS 4000 - Civil Rights and Congress I Credits: 4
- AS 4001 - Civil Rights and Congress II Credits: 4
- AS 4212 - Early America Credits: 4
- AS 4215 - Critical Ideas in American History Credits: 4
- AS 4218 - Civil War and Reconstruction Credits: 4
- AS 4222 - The Emergence of Modern America Credits: 4
- AS 4250 - Immigration Today Credits: 4
- AS 4252 - Immigration History Credits: 4
- AS 4253 - Latino New York Credits: 4
- AS 4282 - America in War and Peace: 1898 to 2001 Credits: 4
- AS 4283 - America Between the World Wars Credits: 4

- AS 4285 - Vietnam and After Credits: 4
- AS 4290 - Youth in America: A History Credits: 4
- AS 4292 - United States Since World War II Credits: 4
- AS 4402 - History of the Family in the U.S. Credits: 4
- AS 4420 - History of New York City and State Credits: 4
- AS 4432 - History of the Women's Movement Credits: 4
- AS 4435 - Women of Color Feminisms Credits: 4
- AS 4715 - African-American Thought and Culture Credits: 4

2. Media Studies Courses (8 credits)

Students select two of the following Media Studies electives:

- MC 2652 - Media Studies Credits: 4
- AS 2700 - The Engaged Eye Credits: 4
- AS 3310 - From Citizen to Consumer Credits: 4
- MC 3622 - Sports, Media, and Society Credits: 4
- MC 3632 - History of U.S. Film Credits: 4
- MC 3700 - PR & Strategic Communications Credits: 4
- MC 3712 - American Film Genres Credits: 4
- MC 3722 - History of Mass Media Credits: 4
- MC 3732 - Politics of Media Credits: 4
- MC 3735 - Documentary Media Studies Credits: 4
- MC 3742 - Myths and Images in Film Credits: 4
- MC 3745 - Film and Gender Credits: 4
- MC 3750 - AI & Society Credits: 4
- MC 3810 - Music and Media Credits: 4
- MC 3830 - Public Relations and Society Credits: 4
- MC 3842 - African Americans and the Mass Media Credits: 4
- MC 3852 - Women and the Media Credits: 4
- MC 4160 - Special Topics in Media Studies Credits: 4
- MC 4280 - Global Media Credits: 4
- MC 4722 - Film: Ideas and Aesthetics Credits: 4
- AS 4725 - The Photograph and American Culture Credits: 4

- MC 4729 - Media & Popular Culture Credits: 4
- MC 4732 - Political Film Credits: 4
- MC 4735 - Latin American Cultures & Media Credits: 4
- MC 4850 - Digital Revolution Credits: 4
- SY 4651 - Sociology of Communications and Media Credits: 4

3. Writing, Analysis and Research (12 credits)

Students are required to take all three of the following:

- MC 2802 - Multimedia Storytelling Credits: 4
- MC 3800 - Writing for Media Credits: 4
- MC 4802 - Investigative Reporting Credits: 4

4. Media Production Courses (8 credits)

Students select two of the following Media Production courses (no more than one VA course):

- MC 2020 - New Media Credits: 4
- MC 2901 - Introduction to Video & TV Credits: 4
- MC 2902 - Introduction to Radio Production Credits: 4
- MC 2910 - Podcasting and Audio Storytelling Credits: 4
- MC 3822 - TV and Radio Journalism Credits: 4
- MC 3835 - Multimedia Newsroom Credits: 4
- MC 3860 - Special Topics in Media Production Credits: 4
- MC 4150 - Radio on the Air Credits: 4
- MC 4260 - New Media Beat Credits: 4
- MC 4442 - Feature Writing Credits: 4
- MC 4700 - Digital PR Campaigns Credits: 4
- MC 4812 - Editing For Publication Credits: 4
- MC 4822 - Digital News Lab Credits: 4
- MC 4852 - Advanced Video: Documentary Credits: 4
- MC 4870 - Advanced TV: Studio Production Credits: 4
- MC 4882 - Radio Reporting Credits: 4
- MC 4935 - TV in Action Credits: 4
- MC 4940 - Journalism in Action Credits: 4

- MC 4945 - Radio in Action Credits: 4
- MC 4955 - New Media in Action Credits: 4
- MC 4965 - Video in Action Credits: 4
- VA 2320 - Graphic Design I Credits: 4
- VA 2400 - Introduction to Photography Credits: 4
- VA 3400 - Digital Imaging Credits: 4
- VA 4260 - Interactive Web Design Credits: 4
- VA 4265 - 3D Digital Design Credits: 4
- VA 4320 - Graphic Design II Credits: 4
- VA 4360 - Advanced 3D Design and Animation Credits: 4
- VA 4460 - Digital Animation Credits: 4

5. Upper-Division Media Electives (8 credits)

Students select two additional upper-division courses in Media Studies and/or Media Production, at least one of which must be at the 3000/4000- level and the other at the 4000-level or above.

6. Internship (4 credits)

Students may take up to twelve internship credits, but only four credits count toward the major. Students may take an internship off campus, but may also take an internship on campus at The Catalyst (campus news site), the Media Innovation Center (MIC), OWTV (Old Westbury TV), or OWWR (Old Westbury's Web Radio station).

- MC 4832 - Internship in Journalism and Media Credits: 1-12
- MC 4835 - Media Innovation Center Fellows Credits: 1-12

7. Capping Course (4 credits)

Students select one of the following senior-level courses:

- AS 5000 - Topics in U.S. History in Global Perspective Credits: 4
- AS 5001 - Capstone Seminar in Black Studies Credits: 4
- AS 5112 - American Voices Credits: 4
- MC 5200 - Environmental Journalism Credits: 4
- AS 5212 - Narrative and History Credits: 4
- AS 5312 - History of US Culture Credits: 4
- AS 5350 - History of the Slave Narrative Credits: 4

- AS 5412 - Protest and Change Credits: 4
- MC 5420 - Propaganda and Mass Persuasion Credits: 4
- MC 5725 - Senior Media Portfolio Credits: 4
- AS 5800 - Research in American History and Culture Credits: 4
- MC 5862 - The Journalist as Creative Writer Credits: 4

8. Portfolio Recommended

All Media and Communications majors should assemble a portfolio for recognition of academic work and for employment. The Portfolio should contain samples of work done in courses and the Internship in Media. The portfolio should contain examples of written work, both published and submitted as class assignments, and selected graphics, radio programs and videos.

General Electives

In consultation with Academic Advisor

Liberal Education Curriculum

To learn more about Old Westbury's Liberal Education Curriculum requirements, see the LEC web page: https://www.oldwestbury.edu/division/office-academic-affairs/liberal-education-core.

Program Policies:

1. All Media and Communications majors should see an adviser at least once a semester.
2. Only one grade of D+, D or D- will be accepted toward the major. Students must request this inclusion from the chair of American Studies.
3. A minimum GPA of 2.0 must be achieved in the major.
4. Only two 1000 or 2000 level courses will be counted towards the major beyond AS 2802 and the "Knowledge of American Society" courses AS 2252, AS 2262, AS 2263, AS 2300, AS 2640.
5. Only one course from the Visual Arts Department will be counted toward the major.
6. In order to qualify for independent study, students must have at least sophomore standing and a B (3.0) average. Only four credits of independent study will be counted toward the major.
7. Only four credits of internship can be applied toward the major. Students can take up to twelve credits which will be counted as elective credit toward graduation, but only four will be applied toward the major. Students must see an adviser to plan their internship.

8. Only five courses can be transferred from another college or university and accepted for credit toward the major. At lease one Media Production course must be taken at SUNY Old Westbury, rather than transferred in.
9. In general, 4000 and 5000 level courses will NOT be offered during the summer sessions.
10. All students in their senior year should communicate with the department chair to make sure that they are on track for graduation.
